03 LAND & NATURAL ASSETS

Land

A practical framework for reviewing land rights, site conditions, permitted use, and holding obligations.

THE INVESTMENT LENS

Land is highly dependent on its legal boundaries, location, physical characteristics, existing rights, and permitted use. A site's possibilities should not be confused with approved development or an established ability to generate income. Any assessment depends on independent, jurisdiction-specific legal, technical, environmental, and planning work.

Considerations

- Confirm surveyed boundaries, registered ownership, legal access, possession, encumbrances, and any customary or community rights.
- Verify current planning or zoning, allowable uses, development conditions, and the approvals actually required for a proposed use.
- Study topography, soils, drainage, flood exposure, utilities, water, road access, and environmental constraints.
- Model holding costs, tax, insurance, site security, land management, and the time and expense of seeking permits.

Risks to understand

- A change of use, rezoning, subdivision, or development approval may be delayed, restricted, or refused.
- Unknown title defects, boundary disputes, access limitations, competing rights, or disputes with neighboring or local stakeholders.
- Contamination, protected habitats, unstable soils, water constraints, flood, wildfire, or other site conditions may add cost or limit use.
- Undeveloped land may produce little or no income while ongoing costs continue; resale and financing can be challenging.

BEFORE CONSIDERING AN OPPORTUNITY

Start with the questions that matter.

01 What title, cadastral, boundary, access, easement, mineral, water, community, or customary rights have been independently confirmed?

02 Which uses are permitted today, and have qualified local advisers confirmed each proposed approval and its requirements?

03 Are independent environmental, ecological, geotechnical, topographical, flood, and utility assessments available for the site?

04 What is the fully costed holding and site-management plan if approvals, a sale, or a proposed development take longer than expected?

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